

B&H Photo Video — Used Department

Sell Used Prototype Review · Session Notes

Jun 24, 2026 | Prototype: **bh_sell_used_lofi_v01**

Attendees

Jerel Smith (PM)

Isaac Mittelman (Director, Used)

Fred Lemonthal (Contact Center)

Avi Schwartz (Customer Care)

Birdie Park Abraham (Research)

John Keeler (UX)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This session was a stakeholder walkthrough of the **bh_sell_used_lofi_v01 prototype** covering the happy-path seller journey: landing → search → item identification → condition self-assessment → accessories → quote cart → submission → confirmation. The group included the Used Dept leadership, Contact Center, Customer Care, and the UX/Research team. The primary goal was a sniff-test before advancing to formal user testing with real sellers.

The session produced substantive decisions on copy, UX patterns, shipping-label logistics, address handling, mixed-quote scenarios (instant + quote-by-mail), and the quote confirmation page experience. The team aligned on proceeding to a scripted user test with prototype updates baked in, targeting a review touchpoint **Thursday of the following week**.

KEY DECISIONS & DISCUSSION OUTCOMES

1. Prototype Scope & Orientation

- Session opened with a rapid 5-minute crash course for attendees new to the work (Fred, Avi).
- Prototype covers the **happy path only** — trade-in fork, search edge cases, and rejection flows are explicitly deferred.
- Competitive references confirmed: **KEH** and **MPB** are the two primary benchmarks; Jerel has a markup/screenshot database available for sharing.
- The return-process framing was surfaced: the seller intake process mirrors a product return. **Narvar** was cited as a reference for post-submission communication UX; Crate & Barrel uses it. Jerel to investigate applicability.

2. Search / Item Identification

- **Type-ahead / autocomplete** confirmed as next build priority for the search box. Three characters triggers suggestions. Infrastructure path is **Apache Solr** (same as the rest of the B&H; site — not yet integrated into Sell Used).
- Expanded item view (big/bold image) confirmed as fallback when PDP-quality images are unavailable.
- 3D item view explored as a future option to reduce wrong-model submissions — noted as a longer-horizon idea.
- Reducing wrong-model identification was reinforced as a core goal; a mismatch voids any quoted price.

3. Mixed-Quote Scenario (Instant + Quote-by-Mail)

- When a seller adds items where **one is recognized** (instant quote) and **one is not** (quote-by-mail), the overall quote total shows as **TBD**.
- The quote confirmation screen must be forked: use **"Quote Pending"** language (not "Confirmed") when a custom/unrecognized item is in the basket. A quote number is still generated.

- Prepaid FedEx label: **cannot be issued** when any item in the quote requires manual review (quote-by-mail). Copy on the confirmation screen must explain the absence of the label — especially important as the flow is moving toward providing the label immediately at submission (rather than via follow-up email).
- Post-submission, the Used team receives the quote-by-mail items, reviews them, and updates the quote — typically within **2–3 hours**.
- Items not in the system can still be processed: evaluators manually handle them and either price them or decline; they communicate via email.

4. Payment Method & Address Handling

- Two addresses may be needed: **return shipping address** (where B&H; sends the item back if needed / what goes on the FedEx label) and **check mailing address** (if payment by check is selected).
- When a customer selects **Check**, a confirmation prompt should appear asking whether the check should go to the shipping address already provided — similar to a "billing same as shipping" pattern in e-commerce.
- Action: **Brendan Bagley** (PM for My Account) should be looped in to understand what saved addresses are surfaced from a logged-in account — potentially pre-populating the shipping/check fields. This is a known unknown; Jerel to initiate that conversation.
- EFT / Direct Deposit confirmed as a payment option, contingent on the ACH project timeline. If not ready, it will be hidden.
- Quote form (the PDF sent to the Used team) will be auto-populated from the data collected in the new flow, not a separate manual form.

5. Quote Confirmation Page

- The current experience has a 5-minute gap between quote submission and the confirmation email arriving in the inbox — a missed opportunity. The new confirmation page should fill that gap immediately.
- **All documents** (quote, prepaid FedEx label, packing instructions) available to download/print on the confirmation page; the same documents will also arrive by email for future reference.
- **Items checklist UX debate:** An interactive checkbox UI risks looking like a required action gate. Decision: use an **expandable/collapsible items list** (no checkboxes) so sellers can verify what they included without implying it is an interactive submit step.
- Copy direction for the confirmation page: **lead with "You're going to get paid"** as the primary message. The caveat (if condition assessment changes, we'll reach out) should be secondary, not the opening line.
- FedEx receipt instructions: strengthen language from passive ("you'll be given a receipt") to imperative — **"Make sure to keep your FedEx receipt"** — with emphasis on it as proof of drop-off. Competitors do this well.

6. Post-Submission Steps Display

- Current design shows **5 numbered steps** on the confirmation page. Feedback: numbers feel intimidating; steps 2 and 3 overlap.
- Decision: **Consolidate to 3–4 steps maximum**, use bullets or icons (not numbers). Suggested grouping: (1) Pack & ship, (2) [Waiting — not an action, make it a paragraph], (3) Get paid.
- Waiting / evaluation is not an action step for the customer. Reframe as informational text, not a numbered item.
- Pre-ship / post-ship phasing surfaced as a possible structural device — two high-level phases with sub-bullets rather than a flat numbered list.

7. Shipping Address Friction

- Some attendees found it surprising/confusing that a shipping address is requested early in the seller flow. Recommendation: add a **brief explanatory line** near the address field — e.g., "This is where we'll ship your item

back if needed, and where your FedEx label originates."

- Logged-in state: surface saved addresses from My Account to reduce re-entry friction (Brendan Bagley alignment needed).

8. Post-Quote Status Tracking

- Idea surfaced (Jerel): if a customer is logged in and returns to the B&H; site with an active sell quote, surface a contextual notification (tray, bottom sheet, or banner) linking them back to their quote status.
- Longer-term: quote status visible in **My Account** — differentiated from product purchase quotes already there. Brendan Bagley owns My Account; revitalizing account notifications is an existing open discussion.
- Customers could also search for their quote number from the main site search to access status — worth exploring.
 - This is a new/additive idea; not in current prototype scope. Flagged as a future requirement.

9. MPB Competitive Reference

- MPB cited as doing a strong job of **post-submission hand-holding** — clear step-by-step communication after quote submission.
- Jerel has a competitive analysis markup (screenshots, annotated design file) comparing KEH, MPB, and Adorama — available to share with the team.

ACTION ITEMS & NEXT STEPS

#	Action Item	Owner	Priority
1	Incorporate all session feedback into bh_sell_used_lofi_v01 prototype (quote pending state, label copy, confirmation page copy, steps consolidation, address micro-copy).	John Keeler	High
2	Deliver updated prototype to Jerel by Monday (to allow test script alignment by Thursday).	John Keeler	High
3	Finalize user test script incorporating new prototype changes; schedule stakeholder review of script for Thursday of the following week (same group).	Jerel Smith	High
4	Initiate conversation with Brendan Bagley (My Account PM) re: saved address surfacing in seller flow and quote status notification in logged-in state.	Jerel Smith	Medium
5	Investigate Narvar for post-submission communication UX patterns applicable to seller flow. Share findings with group.	Jerel Smith	Medium
6	Share competitive analysis markup (KEH, MPB, Adorama screenshots) with Fred and Avi ahead of next session.	Jerel Smith	Medium
7	Confirm ACH / EFT project timeline with relevant team to determine if Direct Deposit payment option is includable at launch.	Jerel Smith	Medium
8	Confirm current quote form (PDF) population logic with Used Dept: verify that data collected in new flow pre-populates the form correctly, eliminating manual re-entry.	Isaac Mittelman	Medium
9	Review and provide feedback on draft confirmation page copy when sent out via email post-session.	Fred Lemonthal / Avi Schwartz	Low

10	Book follow-up session (same group) for Thursday of the following week — testable prototype + finalized test script review.	Jerel Smith	High
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DEFERRED TOPICS (OUT OF SCOPE FOR ROUND 1 TESTING)

Topic	Notes
Trade-In Fork	Requires a separate 2-hour session. Open questions around trade-in campaigns, buying team alignment, Como team, and merchandising. Planned as Round 2 user testing.
Search edge cases	Unrecognized items, partial matches, items B&H; does not purchase (e.g., drones) — intentional failure scenario designed but rejection handling flows not yet prototyped.
B2B / batch selling	Flagged but not scoped. Multiple-item selling for dealers/professionals.
3D item view	Exploratory idea for item identification; no timeline.
My Account quote status	Post-submission quote tracking surfaced in this session; requires Brendan Bagley alignment and is additive scope.
Logged-in address pre-fill	Dependent on My Account roadmap; Brendan Bagley to be consulted.
Narvar / return-process UX	Competitive reference for post-submission comms; research task for Jerel.
Notification system revamp	Brendan Bagley owns; existing open discussion. Flagged as an easy win for quote-status notifications.

USER TESTING PLAN — ROUND 1 OVERVIEW

Target participants:

- Customers who have sold or attempted to sell a used item (camera, lens, audio/video gear) in the past 6–12 months.

Test scenario (3-item design):

Scenario Item	Expected Outcome	Purpose
Sony A7 IV mirrorless camera	Success — instant quote	Happy path validation
Aperture light panel	Success — instant quote	Non-camera item validation
Drone (any brand)	Intentional failure — B&H does not buy drones	Test comprehension of exclusion policy

Key testing questions (tiered):

- **Tier 1 (must-answer):** Does the quoted price feel valid / trustworthy? Is the non-binding nature of the quote understood?
- **Tier 1 (must-answer):** Do participants expect to receive a prepaid shipping label as part of this process?
- **Tier 2:** Where does friction occur in item identification / condition self-assessment?
- **Tier 2:** Is the accessories upsell understood as adding value to the quote total?
- **Tier 3:** How deep does item search need to go before the seller feels confident they found the right item?

Note: Condition pre-selection was removed from the prototype prior to this session to eliminate participant bias during testing.

Mobile and desktop testing will run concurrently (not sequentially) to avoid timeline delays.